Brainstorming & Ideation Phase

Implement Client Script & UI Policy (Incident)

1. Introduction

The Incident Management process in ServiceNow is used to record, track, prioritize, and resolve incidents reported by users. During the brainstorming and ideation phase, the main focus is to identify problems in the Incident form and design simple solutions using Client Scripts and UI Policies.

The proposed implementation aims to make the Incident form easier to use, reduce manual errors, improve data quality, and ensure that important information is entered before an incident is submitted.

2. Problem Identification

The following common problems were considered during brainstorming:

- Users may leave important fields empty while creating an incident.
- Some fields may not be relevant for every incident.
- Users may accidentally modify fields that should not be changed.
- Repeated manual data entry can increase errors.
- The form may become difficult to understand when too many fields are displayed.

3. Main Objective

The main objective is to create a controlled and user-friendly Incident form. Client Scripts will handle client-side logic and field behaviour, while UI Policies will control field visibility, mandatory status, and read-only behaviour.

4. Brainstorming Ideas

Different ideas were discussed before selecting the final approach. The ideas focus on automation, validation, usability, and consistency in Incident Management.

Idea 1 – Mandatory Fields

Important fields such as Short Description, Description, Category, Impact, and Urgency can be made mandatory when required. This helps ensure that sufficient information is available for incident processing.

Idea 2 – Show or Hide Fields

Some fields can be displayed only when they are relevant. For example, additional information can be shown when a particular Category or Subcategory is selected.

Idea 3 – Read-Only Fields

Certain fields can be made read-only after a particular condition is met. This prevents unnecessary changes and protects important incident information.

Idea 4 – Automatic Field Values

A Client Script can automatically set or update a field based on the user's selection. This reduces repetitive data entry and saves time.

Idea 5 – Client-Side Validation

Client Scripts can validate information before the form is submitted. If required data is missing or incorrect, the user can be prompted to correct it.

5. Selection of the Proposed Approach

After comparing the ideas, the proposed solution is to combine Client Scripts and UI Policies. UI Policies will be preferred for simple field behaviour, while Client Scripts will be used when conditional logic or validation requires scripting.

6. Proposed System Design

The proposed Incident form will use two ServiceNow features together. Each feature has a specific responsibility.

Feature	Purpose	Example
UI Policy	Control field behaviour	Make a field mandatory or read-only
UI Policy Action	Apply the policy to a field	Set Mandatory = True
Client Script	Perform client-side logic	Set a value based on user input
onChange Script	React to field changes	Run logic when Category changes
onSubmit Script	Validate before submission	Check required information
onLoad Script	Run when form opens	Set initial field behaviour

7. Example Scenario

Suppose an Incident is created with a high Impact or Urgency. Based on the selected conditions, the system can require additional information from the user. A UI Policy can make the relevant field mandatory, while a Client Script can perform additional validation or update another field.

Expected workflow:

1. User opens the Incident form.
2. User enters the Incident details.
3. A field value changes.
4. The UI Policy checks the defined condition.
5. Required fields become mandatory or relevant fields are displayed.
6. Client Script performs additional client-side logic when required.
7. User corrects any validation issues and submits the Incident.

8. Expected Benefits

The proposed implementation is expected to provide the following benefits:

- Better data quality in Incident records.
- Fewer incomplete Incident submissions.
- Reduced manual work for users.
- Improved usability of the Incident form.
- Consistent handling of important fields.
- Reduced chances of accidental modification of controlled fields.
- Faster and more organized Incident creation.

9. Implementation Plan

The implementation can be completed in a series of simple steps. First, the required Incident fields and business conditions are identified. Next, suitable UI Policies are created for field visibility, mandatory status, and read-only behaviour. Client Scripts are then added for situations that require dynamic logic or validation.

Implementation Steps

1. Study the existing Incident form.
2. Identify fields that require special behaviour.
3. Define conditions for each field.
4. Create the required UI Policies and UI Policy Actions.
5. Create Client Scripts for dynamic logic and validation.
6. Test the form with different Incident conditions.
7. Correct errors and verify the final behaviour.
8. Document the completed configuration.

10. Conclusion

The Brainstorming and Ideation phase provides a clear foundation for implementing Client Scripts and UI Policies in ServiceNow Incident Management. By identifying problems before implementation and selecting suitable solutions, the Incident form can be made more efficient, consistent, and user-friendly. The combination of UI Policies and Client Scripts supports better data entry and smoother Incident management.